

Routine A — Foundations

Photocopy this page and keep it beside your chair.



Warm-up · 1
min



1 · Mountain · 5
breaths



2 · Breathing
Hands · 5



3 · Lifting the
Water · 3



4 · Turning the
Waist · 4 each



16 · Closing · 3
breaths

Chair Tai Chi for Seniors Over 60 · Ellen Whitcombe · Move slowly, within comfort, and never hold your breath.

Routine B — The Everyday Routine

Photocopy this page and keep it beside your chair.



Warm-up · 2
min



1 · Mountain · 3
breaths



3 · Lifting the
Water · 3



5 · Clouds · 4
each



6 · White Crane
· 3 each



8 · Push the
Mountain · 4



10 · Heel and
Toe · 8



11 · Stepping ·
6 each



16 · Closing · 3
breaths

Chair Tai Chi for Seniors Over 60 · Ellen Whitcombe · Move slowly, within comfort, and never hold your breath.

Routine D — The Mini-Routine

For bed, low-energy days, or a tight space. Photocopy and keep it close.



2 · Breathing
Hands · 3



3 · Lifting the
Water · 3



5 · Clouds, one
hand · 4 each



10 · Heel and
Toe · 8



16 · Closing · 3
breaths

Chair Tai Chi for Seniors Over 60 · Ellen Whitcombe · Move slowly, within comfort, and never hold your breath.

The 16 movements at a glance: 1 to 8

Numbers match Chapter 5. Photocopy these pages and keep them beside your chair.



1 · Sitting Like a Mountain



2 · Breathing Hands



3 · Lifting the Water



4 · Turning the Waist



5 · Wave Hands Like Clouds



6 · White Crane



7 · Fair Lady Works the Shuttles



8 · Pushing the Mountain

Chair Tai Chi for Seniors Over 60 · Ellen Whitcombe · Move slowly, within comfort, and never hold your breath.

The 16 movements at a glance: 9 to 16

Numbers match Chapter 5. Photocopy these pages and keep them beside your chair.



9 · Rolling the Ball



10 · Heel and Toe



11 · Stepping in Place



12 · Golden Rooster



13 · Kicking with the Heel



14 · Needle at the Bottom of the Sea



15 · Embracing the Moon



16 · Closing Form

Chair Tai Chi for Seniors Over 60 · Ellen Whitcombe · Move slowly, within comfort, and never hold your breath.

My Day-by-Day Log (1 of 4)

Day	Practice	Done	How I felt
Day 1	Warm-up + 1, 2, 16 · self-checks	☐	
Day 2	Warm-up + 1, 2, 16	☐	
Day 3	Warm-up + 1, 2, 16	☐	
Day 4	Add 3 and 4	☐	
Day 5	Routine A	☐	
Day 6	Routine A	☐	
Day 7	Rest or warm-up only	☐	
Day 8	Routine A	☐	
Day 9	Routine A	☐	
Day 10	Routine A + next steps	☐	
Day 11	Routine A	☐	
Day 12	Routine A	☐	
Day 13	Routine A	☐	
Day 14	Rest or warm-up only	☐	

My Day-by-Day Log (2 of 4)

Day	Practice	Done	How I felt
Day 15	Routine A + 5	☐	
Day 16	Routine A + 5	☐	
Day 17	Routine A + 5, 6	☐	
Day 18	Routine A + 5, 6	☐	
Day 19	Routine A + 5, 6	☐	
Day 20	Routine A + 5, 6	☐	
Day 21	Rest or warm-up only	☐	
Day 22	Add 7	☐	
Day 23	Add 7	☐	
Day 24	Add 8	☐	
Day 25	Routine B	☐	
Day 26	Routine B	☐	
Day 27	Routine B	☐	
Day 28	Rest or warm-up only	☐	

My Day-by-Day Log (3 of 4)

Day	Practice	Done	How I felt
Day 29	Routine B + 9	☐	
Day 30	Routine B + 9, 10	☐	
Day 31	Routine B + 9, 10	☐	
Day 32	Routine B + 9, 10, 11	☐	
Day 33	Routine B + 9, 10, 11	☐	
Day 34	Routine B + 9, 10, 11	☐	
Day 35	Rest or warm-up only	☐	
Day 36	Routine B + 12	☐	
Day 37	Routine B + 9 to 12	☐	
Day 38	Routine B + 9 to 12	☐	
Day 39	Routine B + 9 to 12	☐	
Day 40	Routine B + 9 to 12	☐	
Day 41	Routine B + 9 to 12 · self-checks	☐	
Day 42	Rest or warm-up only	☐	

My Day-by-Day Log (4 of 4)

Day	Practice	Done	How I felt
Day 43	Movements 1 to 8 + 13	☐	
Day 44	Movements 9 to 16	☐	
Day 45	1 to 8 + 13, 14	☐	
Day 46	9 to 16 + 15	☐	
Day 47	1 to 8	☐	
Day 48	9 to 16	☐	
Day 49	Rest or warm-up only	☐	
Day 50	Routine C	☐	
Day 51	Routine C	☐	
Day 52	Routine C	☐	
Day 53	Routine C	☐	
Day 54	Routine C	☐	
Day 55	Routine C · self-checks	☐	
Day 56	Routine of your choice	☐	

My Weekly Log (weeks 1–4)

Week 1	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Week 2	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Week 3	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Week 4	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

My Weekly Log (weeks 5–8)

Week 5	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Week 6	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Week 7	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Week 8	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Practised	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Routine (A–D)							

Movement Cue Cards (1 of 4)

Sitting Like a Mountain



Sit on the front half of your chair with your feet flat and hip-width apart.

Rock gently side to side until you feel the two bones you sit on. Settle evenly on both.

Breathing Hands



Sit tall. Rest one hand on top of the other just below your navel. Breathe in slowly and feel your hands rise as your belly fills.

Lifting the Water



Sit tall with your hands resting on your thighs, palms down.

Let your shoulders drop and your elbows feel heavy.

Turning the Waist



Sit tall with your hands on your thighs and both feet flat.

Breathe out and turn slowly from the waist to look to your right. Keep your hips still.

Movement Cue Cards (2 of 4)



Wave Hands Like Clouds

Sit tall. Hold an imaginary ball in front of your belly: left hand on top, right hand below.

Keep your elbows soft and your fingers relaxed.



White Crane Spreads Its Wings

Sit tall. Cross your wrists in front of your chest, palms facing you.

Breathe in and pause for a moment.



Fair Lady Works the Shuttles

Sit tall and hold the imaginary ball at your right side, right hand on top. Breathe in.



Pushing the Mountain

Sit tall. Draw both hands back beside your ribs, palms facing forward, elbows soft.

Breathe in.

Movement Cue Cards (3 of 4)



Rolling the Ball

Sit tall. Hold an imaginary ball in front of your belly, right hand on top and left hand below. Keep the elbows soft and away from your sides.



Heel and Toe

Sit tall with both feet flat, hip-width apart, hands resting on your thighs. Slowly lift both heels, pressing the balls of the feet into the floor. Lower them.



Stepping in Place

Sit tall, hands resting on your thighs. Shift your weight gently onto your left sitting bone. Let your right foot become light and lift the right knee about an inch, the foot hovering.



Golden Rooster Lifts Its Knee

Sit tall with your hands resting on your thighs and both feet flat. Breathe in and feel your weight settle onto your left sitting bone.

Movement Cue Cards (4 of 4)



Kicking with the Heel

Sit tall and hold the sides of the seat lightly with both hands.

Breathe in.



Needle at the Bottom of the Sea

Sit tall. Let your right hand float up beside your right ear, fingers pointing to the ceiling.

Rest your left hand on your left thigh. Breathe in.



Embracing the Moon

Sit tall with your hands resting on your thighs, palms up.

Breathe in as both arms circle slowly out to the sides and up, palms turning up.



Closing Form

Sit tall. Rest one hand over the other just below your navel.

Let your shoulders drop and your face soften.